



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

## CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



### Let's Start!

What is genetic engineering?



## Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- What problems do you think there could be in the future with things that are genetically modified?
- How much do you worry about ingesting modified plants?

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and subjects of study.
- I can talk about cause and effect.
- I can talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.

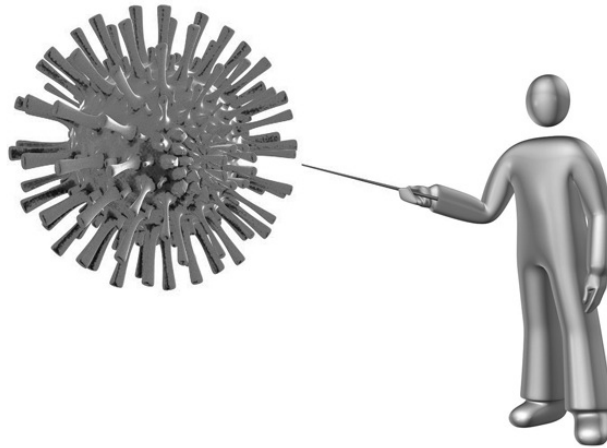




## Let's Explore!

Why are we **playing with nature**\*?

\* "Playing with nature" means using technology to change organisms we find naturally on Earth.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

To whom it may concern,

You are supposed to be a fair editor, so I hope you will print my point of view. As a person who cares about the future of humankind, I feel a need to write this letter. We humans – as well as all the Earth's plants and animals – are creations of nature. What will happen if we tamper with nature? Who will right things if they go dramatically wrong?

Whether you believe that life evolved over millions of years, or that it was created by a greater or divine being, it is still precious. Surely, then, it is unacceptable to approve of the experiments that are being carried out today by genetic engineers. If genetic engineering expands into gene transfer and recombination, it will create new viruses and bacteria. These are viruses that are not supposed to exist. They could easily cause new epidemics. Even if we only meddle with nature in a minor way, it will certainly bring serious consequences. We are supposed to protect nature, not change it. We should think seriously before unwittingly creating problems.

If we allow genetic engineers a free rein, where will it end? Playing with nature is like playing with fire. We should think carefully before we get badly burned!

Sincerely,

A concerned citizen





## Let's Practice!

Thomas writes a brief summary of what he studied at school.

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option to complete the sentences.*

1. It is unacceptable to approve of the experiments that are being carried out today by \_\_\_\_\_. (genetic engineers / genetic enginers / genetics)
2. You may believe that \_\_\_\_\_ millions of years. (life evolved over / live evolved over / life evolves over)
3. Viruses and bacteria \_\_\_\_\_ new epidemics. (could caused easily / could easily cause / could easily caused)
4. If \_\_\_\_\_ into gene transfer and recombination, it will create new viruses and bacteria. (genetical engineering expands / genetic engineering expand / genetic engineering expands)
5. We \_\_\_\_\_ protect nature, not change it. (are suppose to / are supposed to / aren't supposed to)



## Let's Practice!

Lauren points out some personal reflections.

*Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the incorrect words. Write the sentences correctly.*

1. What will hapen if we tampered with nature?  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Who will rights things if they gone dramatically wrong?  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. If we allow genetically engineers a free reign , where will it end?  
\_\_\_\_\_
4. Even if we only meddles with nature in a minor way, it will certainly bring serious consequences.  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. We will caused devastating consequences if we meddle with nature.  
\_\_\_\_\_



## Extension Activity

Write a letter to the editor of a newspaper.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Go online to look at different viewpoints on genetic modification you agree with.
- Choose some ideas that you agree with.
- Use the ideas to write a letter to an editor.
- Explain what you believe, and why.
- Read your letter to a partner.
- Discuss your ideas.

### Self-Assessment

**Yes** **No**

I look up information on genetic modification.

☐ ☐

I choose ideas for a letter.

☐ ☐

I write a letter to an editor on genetic modification.

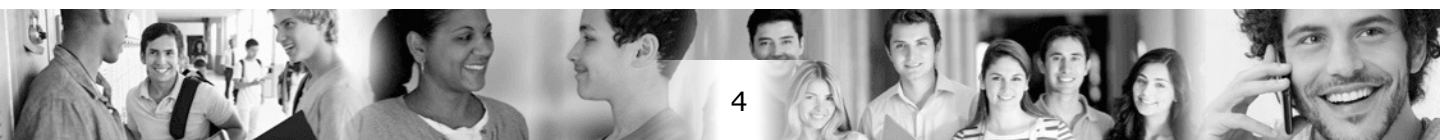
☐ ☐

I share my letter and discuss the ideas.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **to tamper** (verb): to meddle, especially for the purpose of altering, damaging, or misusing  
e.g. What will happen if we tamper with nature?
- **dramatically** (adverb): suddenly or obviously  
e.g. Who will right things if they go dramatically wrong?
- **to evolve** (verb): to develop (a characteristic) by evolutionary processes  
e.g. You may believe that life evolved over millions of years.
- **divine** (adjective): of or relating to a god, especially the supreme being  
e.g. Whether you believe that life evolved over millions of years, or that it was created by a greater or divine being, it is still precious.
- **recombination** (noun): the natural or artificial rearrangement of genetic material in living organisms or viruses  
e.g. If genetic engineering expands into gene transfer and recombination, it will create new viruses and bacteria.
- **epidemic** (noun): an outbreak of a contagious disease that spreads rapidly and widely  
e.g. Some virus could easily cause new epidemics.
- **to meddle** (verb): to involve oneself in a matter without right or invitation; interfere officiously and unwantedly  
e.g. Even if we only meddle with nature in a minor way, it will certainly bring serious consequences.
- **unwittingly** (adverb): without intention  
e.g. We should think seriously before unwittingly creating problems.
- **a free rein** (expression): unrestricted liberty of action or decision  
e.g. If we allow genetic engineers a free rein, where will it end?





## Learning Points

### Should and Be Supposed To

You use the modal **should** or the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the present or future that are expected to happen.

The structure is:

Subject + To be + supposed to + verb

*I'm supposed to clean the house this afternoon.*

**\*\*Pronunciation tip\*\*:**

When you say *be supposed to*, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose\_to

### Examples:

- *You are supposed to be a fair editor, so I hope you will print my point of view.*
- *These are viruses that are not supposed to exist.*
- *We are supposed to protect nature, not change it.*
- *We should think seriously before unwittingly creating problems.*
- *We should think carefully before we get badly burned!*





## Learning Points

### The First Conditional

You use the First Conditional to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do something. In that condition, something else will happen.

| Main Clause                                                                 | If Clause                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>What will happen</i>                                                     | <i>if we tamper with nature?</i>                     |
| <i>What will happen</i>                                                     | <i>if they go dramatically wrong?</i>                |
| <i>We will cause devastating consequences</i>                               | <i>if we meddle with nature.</i>                     |
| If Clause                                                                   | Main Clause                                          |
| <i>If genetic engineering expands into gene transfer and recombination,</i> | <i>it will create new viruses and bacteria.</i>      |
| <i>Even if we only meddle with nature in a minor way,</i>                   | <i>it will certainly bring serious consequences.</i> |

